

quickly took efforts to restore Apple to its past glories and started by pulling the plug on its licensing schemes.

The next thing he did was announce that Apple would sell directly to the customer, either over the phone or through the Apple Store, its e-commerce portal. The system was a success and the year ended with two more offerings from Apple – the ‘PowerMac G3’ and the ‘PowerBook G3’.

But most significantly, Jobs buried the hatchet between Apple and Microsoft. Jobs said that for Apple to rise, it should become a better company as opposed to wanting Microsoft to fall. He signed a deal with Bill Gates, as

part of which Mac versions of Office 98 were rolled out and Microsoft invested \$150 million into Apple.



The iconic look of the Mac in the 1990s is still gorgeous.

The ‘iMac G3’ introduced that year was a runaway success. Its funky colours and all of its hardware integrated inside a CRT monitor was unique and instrumental in bringing Apple back into the lime-

light. It also marked the beginning of Apple’s naming convention of prefixing its device names with the letter, ‘i’.

In 1999, the ‘PowerMac G4’ was released as was the ‘PowerBook G3’, which interestingly was the first Macintosh to support WLAN. Incidentally, these machines were also the last to be sold with Mac OS 9, which was based on the old OS.

The following year, Jobs took over as full-time CEO and the Mac OS X, based on the NeXTStep OS was released. The new OS had a completely revamped interface and added the stability, security and reliability of Unix. Rumour has it that the X in OS X is actually a reverence to its Unix-based roots. Others say it points towards NeXT, while it’s plain to see that the ‘X’ is how the Romans wrote 10.

Up, up and away

2001 was possibly the year when Apple did the opposite of a nose dive. With Jobs as the new CEO, Apple finally moved from online stores to actual brick-and-mortar establishments, also called Apple Stores. It was a